

These descriptions remain relevant along with the more modern understanding that has emerged through Developmental Biology, Psychology, and Cognitive Neurosciences.

Physical Development or *Annamaya Kosha* and *Pranamaya Kosha* understood together include bodily awareness and embodied learning through active engagement of all sensorial perceptions.

Emotional and spiritual development or the *Manomaya Kosha* involves becoming aware of and skilfully regulating our emotions. The domain of Socio-emotional and Ethical Development thus emerges as an important domain of development both from the Indian traditions and current research.

The development of the intellect or *Vijnanamaya Kosha* is emphasised to engage meaningfully with the cognitive and conscious aspects of human experience. The domain of Cognitive Development captures this aspect of development.

Anandamaya Kosha or experience of transcendence is best addressed for this age group through art and culture. Thus, including the domain of Aesthetic and Cultural Development makes the educational experience holistic and complete.

NEP 2020 has emphasised on Foundational Literacy and Numeracy as an ‘urgent and necessary prerequisite to learning.’ This emphasis has been realised by giving special attention to Foundational Literacy through the domain of Language and Literacy Development and Foundational Numeracy through the domain of Cognitive Development.

Finally, the Foundational Stage is also seen as setting the foundations for formal schooling. The development of Positive Learning Habits that are more appropriate for a formal school environment becomes another important Curricular Goal for this stage. Thus, the Curricular Goals for the Foundational Stage have been derived by giving equal consideration to the vision and details of NEP 2020, and the domains of development.

Section 1.4

Curricular Goals and Competencies

The Curricular Goals for the Foundational Stage and the Competencies against each of the Curricular Goals have been outlined in this section. Curricular Goals have been numbered as CG-1, CG-2 and so on, while Competencies have been numbered as C-1.1, C-1.2 and so on.

Domain: Physical Development

Table 1.1i

CG-1 Develops habits that keep them healthy and safe	C-1.1	Shows a liking for and understanding of nutritious food and does not waste food
	C-1.2	Practises basic self-care and hygiene
	C-1.3	Keeps school/classroom hygienic and organised
	C-1.4	Practises safe use of material and simple tools
	C-1.5	Shows awareness of safety in movements (e.g., walking, running, cycling, etc.) and acts appropriately
	C-1.6	Understands unsafe situations and asks for help

CG-2 Develops sharpness in sensorial perceptions	C-2.1	Differentiates between shapes, colours, and their shades
	C-2.2	Develops visual memory for symbols and representations
	C-2.3	Differentiates sounds and sound patterns by their pitch, volume, and tempo
	C-2.4	Differentiates multiple smells and tastes
	C-2.5	Develops discrimination in the sense of touch
	C-2.6	Begins integrating sensorial perceptions to get a holistic awareness of their experiences
CG-3 Develops a fit and flexible body	C-3.1	Shows coordination between sensorial perceptions and body movements in various activities
	C-3.2	Shows balance, coordination, and flexibility in various physical activities
	C-3.3	Shows precision and control in working with hands and fingers
	C-3.4	Shows strength and endurance in carrying, walking, and running

Domain: Socio-Emotional and Ethical Development

Table 1.1ii

CG-4 Develops emotional intelligence, i.e., the ability to understand and manage their own emotions, and responds positively to social norms	C-4.1	Starts recognising 'self' as an individual belonging to a family and community
	C-4.2	Recognises different emotions and makes deliberate efforts to regulate them appropriately
	C-4.3	Interacts comfortably with other children and adults
	C-4.4	Shows cooperative behaviour with other children
	C-4.5	Understands and responds positively to social norms in the classroom and school
	C-4.6	Shows kindness and helpfulness to others (including animals, and plants) when they are in need
	C-4.7	Understands and responds positively to different thoughts, preferences, and emotional needs of other children
CG-5 Develops a positive attitude towards productive work and service or 'Seva'	C-5.1	Engages in age-appropriate work at school and/or at home
CG-6 Develops a positive regard for the natural environment around them	C-6.1	Shows care for and joy in engaging with all life forms

Domain: Cognitive Development

Table 1.1iii

CG-7 Makes sense of the world around through observation and logical thinking	C-7.1	Observes and understands different categories of objects and the relationships between them
	C-7.2	Observes and understands cause and effect relationships in nature by forming simple hypotheses and uses observations to explain their hypotheses
	C-7.3	Uses appropriate tools and technology in daily life situations and for learning
CG-8 Develops mathematical understanding and abilities to recognise the world through quantities, shapes, and measures	C-8.1	Sorts objects into groups and sub-groups based on more than one property
	C-8.2	Identifies and implements simple patterns in their surroundings, shapes, and numbers
	C-8.3	Counts up to 99 both forwards and backwards, and in groups of 5s, 10s, and 20s
	C-8.4	Arranges numbers up to 99 in ascending and descending order
	C-8.5	Recognises and uses numerals to represent quantities up to 99 with the understanding of decimal place value system
	C-8.6	Performs addition and subtraction of 2-digit numbers fluently, using flexible strategies of composition and decomposition of both numerical and word problems
	C-8.7	Recognises multiplication as repeated addition and division as equal sharing
	C-8.8	Recognises, makes, and classifies basic geometric shapes, and their observable properties, and understands and explains the relative relation of objects in space
	C-8.9	Selects appropriate tools and units to perform simple measurements of length, weight, and volume of objects in their immediate environment
	C-8.10	Performs simple measurements of time in minutes, hours, days, weeks, and months
	C-8.11	Performs simple transactions using money up to INR 100
	C-8.12	Develops adequate and appropriate vocabulary for comprehending and expressing concepts and procedures related to quantities, shapes, space, and measurements
	C-8.13	Formulates and solves simple mathematical problems related to quantities, shapes, space, and measurements
	C-8.14	Feels confident and sees Mathematics as doable and worthwhile

Domain: Language and Literacy Development

Table 1.1iv

CG-9 Develops effective communication skills for day-to-day interactions in two languages ¹	C-9.1	Listens to and appreciates simple songs, rhymes, and poems
	C-9.2	Creates simple songs and poems on their own
	C-9.3	Converses fluently and can hold a meaningful conversation
	C-9.4	Understands oral instructions for a complex task and gives clear oral instructions for the same to others
	C-9.5	Comprehends narrated or read-out stories and identifies characters, storyline, and what the author wants to say
	C-9.6	Narrates short stories with clear plot and characters
	C-9.7	Knows and uses enough words to carry out day-to-day interactions effectively and can guess the meaning of new words by using existing vocabulary
CG-10 Develops fluency in reading and writing in Language 1	C-10.1	Develops phonological awareness and blends phonemes or syllables into words and segment words into phonemes or syllables
	C-10.2	Understands the basic structure or format of a book, idea of words in print and direction in which they are printed, and recognises basic punctuation marks
	C-10.3	Recognises all the letters of the alphabet (forms of <i>Akshar</i>) of the script, and uses this knowledge to read and write words
	C-10.4	Reads stories and passages with accuracy and fluency, with appropriate pauses and voice modulation
	C-10.5	Reads short stories and comprehends their meaning by identifying characters, storyline and what the author wants to say on their own
	C-10.6	Reads short poems and begins to appreciate a poem for its choice of words and imagination
	C-10.7	Reads and comprehends the meaning of short news items, instructions and recipes, and publicity material
	C-10.8	Writes a paragraph to express their understanding and experiences
	C-10.9	Shows interest in picking up and reading a variety of children's books
CG-11 Begins to read and write in Language 2	C-11.1	Develops phonological awareness and is able to blend phonemes or syllables into words and segment words into phonemes or syllables
	C-11.2	Recognises most frequently occurring letters of the alphabet (forms of <i>Akshar</i>) of the script and uses this knowledge to read and write simple words and sentences

¹ This should be the goal for most classrooms given the need for multilingualism, but in circumstances where Language 2 is very unfamiliar to the children, many of the Competencies (from C-9.1 to C-9.7) can be in the emergent stage for Language 2 by the end of the Foundational Stage and consolidated in the early Preparatory Stage.

Domain: Aesthetic and Cultural Development

Table 1.1v

CG-12 Develops abilities and sensibilities in Visual and performing Arts and expresses their emotions through art in meaningful and joyful ways	C-12.1	Explores and plays with a variety of materials and tools to create two-dimensional and three-dimensional artworks in varying sizes
	C-12.2	Explores and plays with their own voice, body, space, and a variety of objects to create music, role-play, dance, and movement
	C-12.3	Innovates and works imaginatively to express a range of ideas and emotions through the Arts
	C-12.4	Works collaboratively in the Arts
	C-12.5	Communicates and appreciates a variety of responses while creating and experiencing different forms of art, local culture, and heritage

Positive Learning Habits

Table 1.1vi

CG-13 Develops habits of learning that allows them to engage actively in formal learning environments such as a school classroom	C-13.1	Attention and intentional action: Acquire skills to plan, focus attention, and direct activities to achieve specific goals
	C-13.2	Memory and mental flexibility: Develop adequate working memory, mental flexibility (to sustain or shift attention appropriately), and self-control (to resist impulsive actions or responses) that would assist them in learning in structured environments
	C-13.3	Observation, wonder, curiosity, and exploration: Observes minute details of objects, wonders, and explores using various senses, tinkers with objects, asks questions
	C-13.4	Classroom norms: Adopts and follows norms with agency and understanding

Section 1.5 Pedagogy

Children are natural learners. They are active, eager to learn, and respond with interest to new things. They have an innate sense of curiosity, they wonder, question, explore, try out, and discover to make sense of the world. By acting on their curiosity, they continue to discover and learn more.

Children learn best through play, activity and experiencing. They like to run, jump, crawl, and balance, they enjoy repetition, respond spontaneously to rhythm, talk, ask, reason, and answer questions posed to them. They learn through first-hand experiences involving manipulation, exploration, and experimentation.

Engaging with materials, ideas, thoughts, and feelings during play helps in developing children's creativity, flexible thinking, and problem-solving abilities, and enhances their concentration, attention, and perseverance. Children also improve their thinking,